curbing violence in the short term, redistribution and overall development are better strategies to prevent and contain civil unrest in the medium term,' the report says, referring to *Operation Green Hunt* launched against Maoists, which has come under sharp criticism from human rights activists within the country. The other initiatives that have been lauded are the **right to education** and the **rural employment guarantee scheme** (MGNREGA) that provides up to 100 days of unskilled manual labour to eligible poor at a statutory minimum wage. 'This initiative (the job guarantee scheme) is promising because it provides access to income and some insurance for the poor against the vagaries of seasonal work and affords individual the self-respect and empowerment associated with work,' the report says.

INCLUSIVE DEVELOPMENT

This section and the one that follows on social sector initiatives, examine the major dimensions of inclusive development like poverty alleviation, employment generation, health, education, and social welfare besides giving the progress of important government programmes in those sectors.

Inclusive development can be viewed in terms of progress in social and financial inclusion. A large part of the population, particularly segments like landless agricultural labourers, marginal farmers, scheduled castes (SCs), scheduled tribes (STs), and other backward classes (OBCs), continue to suffer social and financial exclusion. Accordingly, the government's policies are directed towards economic and social upliftment of these segments so as to enable everyone to reap the benefits of growth and bring marginalised sections of the society into the mainstream. This is also reflected in social-sector expenditure by the government.

Expenditure on Social Sector

Central support for social programmes has continued to expand in various forms although most social-sector subjects fall within the purview of the states. In the post-reform period, governments concern for the social sector has increased in a big–way. As per the latest *Economic Survey 2012–13*, India's expenditure trends on social sector today are given below –